

to go to the Inbox. Once you get the hang of it, you'll soon be zooming your way effortlessly though Gmail. Unfortunately, this lab feature is designed to work best with Windows.

Optimise your signature (Signature tweaks)

This is a very simple lab feature, which serves two purposes. It places your signature before the quoted text in a reply, and removes the "-" line that appears before signatures. This way, your signature no longer looks like it's auto appended, but something you took the trouble to personally write. To activate, just enable and save changes in Labs.



Spice up your Inbox using plugins

Save screen space (Muzzle)

Some of you popular people out there might have hundreds of people on your chat list. If each has their "unique" status message this might end up making your list a mile long. Activate this feature to hide your friends' status messages. This way you will know who is online, you save space, and you're not subjected to infuriating status messages such as "xxx is really happy to see a unicorn".

Forgotten Attachment detector

Surely, there might have been more than one occasion where you have sent out an email, and then sent out a rectification mail saying "sorry forgot attachment". Save yourself that little embarrassment by activating this feature. It prevents you from accidentally sending messages without the relevant attachments. It automatically scans your body text and prompts you if you mention attaching a file, but forgot to do so.

Add another pane (Multiple Inboxes)

This application lets you add boxes next to your Inbox, where you can view more mails. You can customise which mails you wish to see in these additional panes. The new lists of threads can be labels, your starred messages, drafts or any search you want. So if you pull emails from another mailbox via POP3, you can auto apply a label to them and have those mails displayed alongside your main Inbox. It's like having two or more Inboxes in one mail. To configure this feature, go to Settings and click the Multiple Inbox tab. Here you can define the criteria for up to four panes. However, more than three

panes crowd the available screen space. Examples of search operators for panes are: is: sent, label: external mail", etc.

Changing the appearance (Themes and add-ons)

Gmail may be great, but you'd agree that there really isn't much to look at. Although we're all for simplicity and functionality, a little bit of style is always welcome. So, the guys at Gmail decided to give us themes. To apply any theme, go to the Themes tab in Settings. Some of the themes require you to enter your location. According to Google, these themes will change according to your local time of day. While the themes offered by Gmail are about average, there are other ways to customise your look. Head over to <http://globexdesigns.com/gr/> to install Google Redesigned, a Mozilla Firefox extension designed by Globex Designs that aims to fully redesign the look and feel of popular Google services. Once you have installed the extension, restart your browser and click on the GR icon in the bottom-right corner of your browser and select "Check For Style Updates". This will automatically download and install all the latest styles that are currently available. Alternatively, you can also get the "Stylish" plug-in from <http://userstyles.org/stylish/>. Stylish is to CSS what Greasemonkey is to JavaScript. Just follow the link to Mozilla's add-on page (addons.mozilla.org) and install the plug-in. Once installed, click on the stylish icon in the bottom-right corner of your browser. Click on 'Find styles for this

page' when in Gmail. You will find tons of new styles to choose from. However, run only one of these plug-ins at a time.

Disaster mode

Remember, Gmail Labs is an experimental area. Most features are deployed without much testing. Some of the Labs features can and will occasionally break. Therefore, Gmail has provided you with an escape hatch. If you're having trouble accessing your account, you can temporarily disable labs for your session by logging in from this URL — <http://mail.google.com/mail/?labs=0>.

WINDOWS 7

Windows 7 beta is the latest iteration of the Microsoft Windows operating system. We spent a few days with it. Going back to XP or Vista after a few days on Windows 7 can be very difficult. The user-friendly response can be very addictive. The public beta of the operating system is out, and here is a primer to start you off if you have your hands on it.

Change the Theme

Right-click on the desktop, click on customise. Then, select one of the default themes available to you. You can change the system sounds, and the way the menus



Changing the settings for your Windows 7 desktop

and the bars look. The new feature in Windows 7 is that a theme can have a set of images that cycle automatically after a particular amount of time. The second ease of access theme is a throwback to good old Windows 95.

Windows Media Player

The first time you use Windows Media Player, instead of the default settings, go to the custom settings. Here, disallow